

PIZZOCCHERI ALLA VALTELLINESE

REGION North	SERVES 4-6	TOTAL TIME 1 h plus the dough rest
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INGREDIENTS

1 batch	Buckwheat dough
432 g	Yukon gold potatoes, peeled and diced into ½-inch pieces
28 g	Olive oil
165 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed
5 g	Garlic, thinly sliced
1 kg	Savoy cabbage, cored and cut into 3- to 4-inch strips
120 g	Fontina, coarsely grated and at room temperature
30 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated

METHOD

1. Cut 454 g of pizzoccheri from the buckwheat dough.
2. Boil a small pot of heavily salted water. Cook the potatoes 3 to 5 minutes, until tender but still with a little bite. Drain and set them aside.
3. Set a large saute pan or Dutch oven over medium-low heat with the oil and 30 g of the butter. Add half the garlic and cook it 10 to 15 seconds, until it smells, with no color at all.
4. Tip in the cabbage and cook 3 to 5 minutes, until wilted and tender. Take the pan off the heat.
5. Put a large pot of water on to boil over high heat and salt it heavily.
6. In a small saucepan over medium-low heat, cook the remaining butter with the remaining garlic 3 to 4 minutes, to a foaming golden brown. Set it aside somewhere warm.
7. Cook the pizzoccheri 3 to 5 minutes, until tender without going soft.
8. Set the cabbage pan back over low heat. Lift the pasta across with a spider, add the potatoes and turn everything together gently.
9. Spread half the pasta, cabbage and potato in an even layer in a 9 by 13-inch casserole dish.
10. Scatter half the fontina and half the parmigiano over, then spoon half the warm garlic butter across the cheese.
11. Build a second layer the same way, with the rest of the pasta and cheese and the last of the garlic butter.
12. Take the casserole dish to the table and serve family style.

NOTES

Bitto is the traditional cheese and is hard to find outside the Valtellina. Good Fontina Val d'Aosta is the stand-in. Grate the fontina ahead and let it come to room temperature, so it melts the moment the hot pasta lands on it. Do not toss the finished dish. The two layers of cheese and garlic butter are meant to melt down through the pasta as it sits.

The traditional method boils the potatoes and cabbage first and then cooks the pasta in the same water. This version cooks the cabbage in oil and butter instead and uses separate pots.

Buckwheat was grown in the Valtellina for centuries before this dish was recorded in the eighteenth century, because it is hardy and its growing season is short.

SHAPE

Pizzoccheri

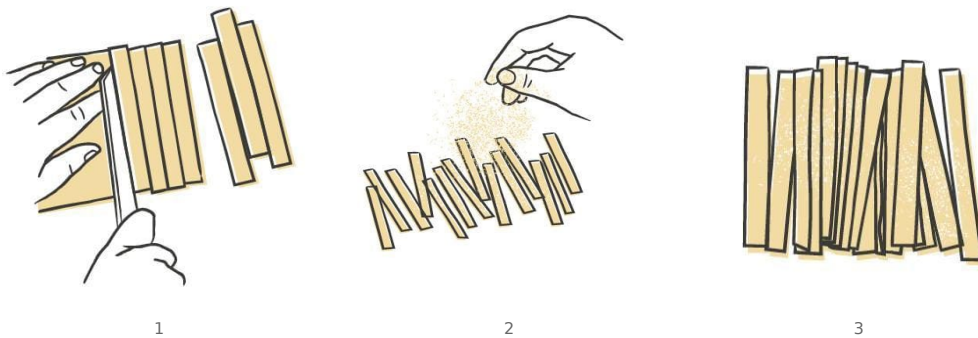
Region: The Valtellina, in Lombardy / Rest: 20-30 min at room temperature

METHOD

1. Make the buckwheat dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Give a wooden work surface a light dusting of 00 flour. Line a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Knife the sheets into 18 by 4 1/2-inch rectangles and trim the ragged edges off. Save the trim for soup. Keep the sheets under plastic or a towel.
4. Lay one sheet down with the long side nearest you. Cut 1/2-inch strands, working inward from one edge.
5. Dust the strands generously with 00 flour, shake them apart, and spread them in a single layer on the pan.
6. Repeat with the rest of the sheets.

7. Dry 20 to 30 minutes at room temperature.
8. To hold, cover the pan with plastic and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

SHAPING



NOTES

This shape needs buckwheat dough, which is not one of the four standard doughs in this collection. The protective consortium's ratio is one part 00 flour to four parts buckwheat. Robbins reverses it, so 00 flour dominates, and uses egg yolk in place of water. The result is less gritty and more pliable. Cut width is 1/2 inch. Sheets get cut to 18 by 4 1/2 inches first. Spread the cut strands in a single layer rather than nesting or coiling them. Refrigerated shelf life is 24 hours. The dish it belongs to is pizzoccheri alla valtellinese, built on cheese, potatoes, butter, and cabbage. It also suits other hearty, vegetable-forward pastas.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____

RATING ____ / 5

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